

Handwriting

**Formations
Grip
Slant
Position
Procedures**

by

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Handwriting

I. Position

- A. Wrist and elbow on table; feet touching floor; body straight and at 45 degree slant toward desk.

II. Paper

- A. Slant paper to assist:
 - slant toward right for left-handers
 - slant toward left for right-handers
- B. Use other hand to anchor paper

III. Slant of letters

- A. To determine natural slant, have students draw the following as nearly vertical as possible two or three times. Then see what slant is best for them.

- a. Downward strokes as nearly vertical as possible



- b. Free loops



IV. Pencil Grip

- A. Note grip:
 - 1) three-point or four-point
 - 2) Close or far from pencil tip
 - 3) Pressure
- B. Fatter pencils or crayons for younger children
- C. Some students need pencil grips to assist

V. Procedures

- A. Teacher models making letters on chalkboard (large letters) and gives letter names (and/or sound) as she writes. She then writes over model and verbalizes formation (head line, belt line, foot line).
- B. Student traces over the teacher's letter as he says letter name (and/or sound). Student could also write the letter in the air while looking at the teacher's model with the finger(s) of his writing hand.
- C. Student could also trace letter on tracing patterns, felt, or sand as he says letter name (and/or sound).
- D. Student then copies the letter on paper - large formation on mid-lined paper as he says letter name (and/or sound)
- E. Student writes letter on trifold paper with or without model as he says letter name (and/or sound).
- F. Child could write on different surfaces or with different materials - with shaving cream, rice tray, sand tray, fingerpaint (also sandpaper letters).

VI. Fluidity

- A. Teacher dictates letter (s) and students write as they say letter names (and/or sound) - vary pace.
- B. Teacher says word and says letter names of the word. Students write as they keep pace with the teacher.

a b c d

e f g h

i j k l

m n o p

q r s t

u v w x

